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The Internet is a scary place and we all want the security of a VPN. But how do we pick the best one?

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A VPN is the veritable jack of all trades when it comes to ensuring your privacy on the big bad internet. With the ability to not only safeguard your privacy and provide you with a level of security, VPNs are also useful in many other ways. Such as allowing you access to geo-restricted content and sometimes even routing your internet connection through a faster set of hubs getting you better connectivity to certain portions of the internet. With the recent FCC rulings in the US, a lot of our private information is about to be accessible to ISPs so that they can sell it off to advertisers. And just because the ruling happened in the US, doesn't mean that we're safe here in India. The internet operates in mysterious ways and US laws are very ambiguous to begin with. If at all, at any point during the transmission of data packets from

your browser enters the geographical boundary of the USA, it falls under US laws and you can bet your ass that whatever ISP is carrying that data within the US will take a peek. And if the website you're visiting happens to serve ads using a platform that's also US based, then there's a good possibility that your browsing habits will be sold by said US ISP to the ad platform.

So what should you do? Well, the first step would be to contemplate if you even care about your privacy. If at the end of your contemplation, your answer to the question happens to be 'f#%k it'. Then by all means, go about your life and don't even bother. However, VPNs are still important for other reasons, if not for your privacy. So should you change your mind sometime in the future, here's what you should know about them.

Do they keep logs?

If at any point, data regarding which websites you're visiting or which IP

you were assigned and which IP you used to connect to an end-point are stored, then you're in trouble. It's as good as not using a VPN since whatever privacy you stood to gain from a VPN was rendered useless because of these logs. Extremely popular VPNs like Hola! VPN, Unlocator and even the built in VPN in Opera browser keep traffic logs. In fact, the VPN service used within Opera logs everything, from your traffic, bandwidth, DNS requests, timestamps and even IP addresses. There's zero privacy should any governmental entity ask Opera to reveal your data. On the other hand, IVPN, NordVPN and BolehVPN keep no logs at all (at the time of writing this). I doubt if you've ever heard of any of these services.

Encryption used?

Not keeping logs is a great facet of a VPN only if coupled with good encryption. Poor encryption would ensure that anyone can use a simple man in the